

SWOT Analysis — Filled Example: Community Fridge Expansion

Project / Organization: Community Fridge crew **Date:** February 2025 **Facilitator:** Volunteer coordinator
Mission focus: Free, dignified, 24/7 food access — growing from one fridge to three.

The Quadrant

STRENGTHS (internal, helpful)	WEAKNESSES (internal, harmful)
1. Trusted, reliable volunteer base	1. Limited cold-chain gear (coolers, backup power)
2. Steady grocery store donation pipeline	2. Volunteer burnout — same 6 people doing everything
3. Engaged online supporter community	3. No formal property agreements for fridge sites

OPPORTUNITIES (external, helpful)	THREATS (external, harmful)
1. City micro-grant for food access projects	1. Rising utility costs at host sites
2. Culinary school seeking community partner	2. Vandalism at unattended sites
3. Local media interest in mutual aid	3. Increased health department inspections

Action Translation

Strength → Opportunity matches

Strength	Opportunity it unlocks	Action	Owner	By when
Grocery donation pipeline (credibility)	City micro-grant	Apply, citing 12 months of donation logs — fund 2 new fridges	Grants lead	Mar 15
Trusted volunteers + online community	Media interest	Pitch “day in the life of a fridge” story; recruit volunteers from coverage	Comms volunteer	Mar 30
Volunteer base	Culinary school partnership	Students prep ready-to-eat meals — relieves volunteer fatigue (Weakness 2)	Coordinator	Apr 10

Threat mitigations

Threat	Mitigation plan	Owner	By when
Inspections	Draft MOUs with property owners defining cleaning schedule & responsibility	Site leads	Apr 1
Vandalism	MOUs add host-site lighting/cameras; community “fridge guardians” rota	Site leads	Apr 1
Rising utilities	Include 12 months of utility support per site in micro-grant budget	Grants lead	Mar 15

Weakness to tackle first: Volunteer burnout — culinary partnership + recruitment from media coverage.

Put It to Work

- ✓ Funder brief updated — micro-grant application frames donations pipeline as proof of capacity
- ✓ Team aligned — burnout is the first weakness to tackle
- ✓ Metrics defined — incidents per site per month; volunteer hours per person per week
- ✓ Next SWOT review scheduled: August 2025 (after fridge #2 launches)

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